

Firearms Trace Data: Minnesota - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Minnesota in Calendar Year 2023

5,206

Firearm Types with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	3,866
Rifles	530
Shotguns	396
Revolvers	298
Machinegun Conversion Devices	58
Machineguns	30
Other*	28

* Other includes Derringers, Receivers/Frames, Any Other Weapons, a Combination, a Flare Gun, a Silencer and an Unknown Type.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	2,501
.40 Cal	428
.22 Cal	380
.45 Cal	326
12GA	301

.380 Cal	270
.38 Cal	123
10mm	76
5.56mm	72
.223 Cal	70
.357 Cal	70

NOTE: There were 471 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 118 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	1,149
Firearm Under Investigation	843
Weapon Offense	593
Found Firearm	525
Dangerous Drugs	379
Aggravated Assault	328
Traffic Offense	254
Family Offense	182
Property Crimes	166
Suicide	147
Homicide	123

NOTE: There were 517 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Minnesota	3,100
Wisconsin	170
North Dakota	81
Indiana	79
Texas	75
Florida	58
Iowa	50
Illinois	49
Georgia	41
Mississippi	36
Arizona	35
Missouri	35
South Dakota	28
Tennessee	28
California	26

NOTE: An additional 33 states accounted for 297 other traces. The source state was identified in 4,188 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	194
3 Months to Under 7 Months	218
7 Months to Under 1 Year	261
1 Year to Under 2 Years	740
2 Years to Under 3 Years	659
3 Years and Over	2,112

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Minnesota Average Time-to-Crime: **6.77 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	151
18 to 21	439
22 to 24	353
25 to 30	661
31 to 40	881
41 to 50	506
Over 50	437

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Minnesota Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Minneapolis	1,523
Saint Paul	720
Brooklyn Park	188
Duluth	152
Brooklyn Center	134
Saint Cloud	116
Maple Grove	98
Rochester	96
Burnsville	80
Blaine	79

NOTE: There were 313 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,016 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for four traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Minnesota. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Minnesota.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Minnesota Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024